ALLY WEALTH

Category Selection Guide

KEYWORDS • AUTHOR RESOURCE LIBRARY

A decision guide for choosing accurate, relevant retailer categories based on book fit, reader expectations and current platform rules rather than vanity rankings.

GET SEEN. GROW YOUR INFLUENCE. BUILD YOUR LEGACY.

How to use this resource

This guide is designed as a practical working document. Read it in sequence or move to the section that addresses your immediate need. Use the prompts to record decisions, assign actions and identify questions that require further research.

A note on platform guidance

Retailer features, metadata options, community rules and promotional policies can change. Verify current requirements with the relevant platform before making changes or launching a campaign. This guide is educational and does not guarantee rankings, reviews, sales or other outcomes.

Your working principles

Be accurate. Put reader relevance before vanity metrics. Respect platform rules and community boundaries. Keep records of decisions. Measure what matters to your goals.

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Section 01

Why categories matter

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about why categories matter. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 02

Start with accurate classification

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about start with accurate classification. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 03

Reader expectation

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about reader expectation. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 04

Genre and subgenre

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about genre and subgenre. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 05

Subject categories

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about subject categories. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 06

Retailer taxonomy changes

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about retailer taxonomy changes. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 07

Research current options

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about research current options. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 08

Competitor observation

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about competitor observation. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 09

Relevance test

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about relevance test. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 10

Audience fit test

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about audience fit test. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 11

Avoid misleading placement

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about avoid misleading placement. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

- Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.
- Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.
- Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.
- Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.
- Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 12

Niche versus broad

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about niche versus broad. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 13

Competition context

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about competition context. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

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• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 14

Category opportunity matrix

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about category opportunity matrix. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

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• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

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Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 15

Metadata consistency

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about metadata consistency. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

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• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 16

Series considerations

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about series considerations. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

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• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 17

Format differences

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about format differences. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

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• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 18

Policy and eligibility

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about policy and eligibility. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

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• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 19

Document your choices

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about document your choices. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 20

Category scoring worksheet

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about category scoring worksheet. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

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Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 21

Selection checklist

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about selection checklist. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

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• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 22

Monitor changes

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about monitor changes. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 23

Review ranking claims

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about review ranking claims. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Section 24

Maintenance plan

This section helps you make a clear, reader-centred decision about maintenance plan. Start by recording what is true about your book, audience and current position. Then separate evidence from assumptions before choosing an action.

What to consider

Begin with the reader's perspective. Ask what a prospective reader needs to understand, what information would help them decide, and whether the material you present is accurate and consistent. Review the surrounding context rather than treating one marketing element in isolation.

Practical sequence

• Write down the current situation and the outcome you want to improve.

• Gather the relevant book details, platform information and examples.

• Check whether each choice is accurate, appropriate and useful to the intended reader.

• Choose one manageable improvement and record who will complete it and when.

• Review the result using a meaningful signal, then document what you learned.

Working questions

What evidence supports this decision? What might confuse or discourage the reader? Which detail needs verification? What is the smallest useful next step?

Your notes

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Working worksheet

Use this page to turn the guide into an action plan. Keep the scope realistic and prioritise the work that most directly supports the reader experience.

Area	Your decision / notes
Current position	
Priority improvement	
Evidence to collect	
Action owner	
Target date	
How success will be reviewed	

Your next 30 days

Choose a small number of actions you can complete consistently. Avoid changing multiple variables at once when you need to understand what made a difference.

Week 1: Review and research

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Week 2: Make the priority improvements

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Week 3: Publish, test or implement

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Week 4: Review evidence and decide what comes next

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Further notes and questions